a FlexLifeFi K-12 program

What to Watch For at Home

One good question per quarter - no quizzing, no pressure.

Grade 10 year theme — Ownership, Money, and Compliance.
The 9-12 band is built for the adults who will scrutinize: parents, teachers, administrators.

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Grade 10 · Parent Guide · the magazine version of the master document, set for adults to read end-to-end.

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GRADE 10 · PARENT GUIDE

What to Watch For Home

The legal, financial, and operational chassis under every venture.

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A short, practical guide for the adult who lives with a Grade 10 Cash to Company student.

WITH CASH - 9-12 VOICE

"An MVP is the smallest test that could change your mind. It's not a v1."

What this year is

> "I don't know either. That's why we test."
>
> - CASH, GRADE 10

This year, your student is learning the parts of business adults usually don't discuss until much later — what kind of thing a venture actually is, how it gets funded, how it's owned, and what laws apply. The big move is **structure**: telling the difference between a hobby, a side hustle, a small business, and a startup; comparing how a loan and a friends-and-family note actually cost differently; reading an operating agreement clause-by-clause; and learning the basic compliance map (license, sales tax, ID-required products, age limits, PII protection).

Across the year, your student designs a Structured Venture Brief — a hypothetical (or sometimes real) venture they sharpen through categorization, funding comparison, ownership-structure analysis, brand work, premortem, and a compliance map. By June, they deliver a 5-minute defense plus a written revision list capturing pushback from a panel.

Most students do not start a real venture this year. The point is **literacy** — the ability to read what's actually going on under the surface of any venture, including ones they'll work for or start later.

What you'll see at home

- A **Capstone Journal** — the messy notebook where they sketch, draft, and reflect.
- A **Student Activity Book** — structured worksheets with categorization tables, APR math, operating agreement clauses, premortem ranking, and compliance maps.
- Occasional **Cash videos** to watch (2:30–3:00 each) — short animated explainers from the program's mascot, Cash.
- A **Capstone Brief** that grows across the year — four packs plus a vision statement.

They'll talk about "categorization," "APR," "operating agreement," "premortem," and "compliance map." You don't need to know these terms — your student will explain.

What you don't need to do

- **You don't need to know any of this.** A parent with no business or legal background can fully support this curriculum.
- **You don't need to fund anything.** Capstones are educational. Real ventures are family decisions outside the curriculum.
- **You don't need to share your finances.** No student is asked to share family financial details. If a homework prompt feels invasive, it isn't required — contact the teacher.
- **You don't need to form an LLC, sign anything, or talk to a lawyer.** The year teaches your student to read and compare — not to act.

AN INTERLUDE · GRADE 10

"Which people, and how do you know?"

the program's spine question.

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What you can do (if you want)

> **"Revenue is loud. Contribution margin is true. Compute one number this week."**
>
> - CASH, GRADE 10

These are optional and low-effort. None are required.

One good question per quarter

- **September–October (Categorization):** "Of businesses you can think of, which is a hobby, a side hustle, a small business, a startup? What's your evidence?"
- **November–January (Funding):** "For a hypothetical $3,000 venture, what's the tradeoff between a bank loan and borrowing from a relative — not just in money, in everything?"
- **February–April (Structure):** "If two people start a venture together, what's the most important thing they should write down before they start?"
- **May–June (Premortem and compliance):** "If your hypothetical venture failed in a year, what's the most likely reason? What would you do about that now?"

You don't need the right answer. You're modeling curiosity. The most useful response to any of your student's answers is "how do you know?"

Notice structure with them

When you encounter a venture in the wild — a coffee shop, a tutoring ad, a relative's side business — wonder out loud: "I bet that's an LLC. Or maybe a sole prop. Hard to tell from outside." Hearing the question modeled helps the literacy stick.

Share a small-business or side-hustle story

If you've ever started something small — a side service, a club, a fundraiser, a freelance gig — your story is valuable. The most useful thing you can share is what you got wrong and what you did about it, including the boring parts about taxes, licenses, or contracts.

Things to watch for

A "great idea" that needs you to spend money

Two responses both work:

- "What did your funding comparison say? Have you done the APR math?" (Pulls them into the work.)
- "This sounds like a real-life version, not a class version. We can talk about that as a family — separately from the homework." (Separates curriculum from family decision.)

Pressure to form an LLC

Some students will come home convinced they should immediately form an LLC. The curriculum is explicit: educational, not advisory. Cash to Company never tells a student to form one. Ask the questions Cash would ask: "What's the cost? The complexity? The liability you're protecting against? Is the venture at the scale where this makes sense?" Most teen ventures are sole prop until they aren't. Real decisions involve a real attorney and a real accountant.

A request for real money

Real money requests are family conversations, not curriculum requirements. The Capstone can be done entirely on paper. Real-money launches fit better in Grade 12 (the launch-ready year).

Something that doesn't sit right

If your student's venture leans toward age-restricted products, exclusionary marketing, body-image messaging, or anything else that pings you, mention it to the teacher. The curriculum has built-in pivot windows three times during the year for exactly this.

Privacy and sensitivity

The curriculum:

- Uses **fictional names** for partnerships, vendors, and lenders.
- Uses **hypothetical ventures** for funding, structure, and compliance work.
- Avoids **family financial details** entirely — no homework asks how much your family spends, owes, owns, or earns.
- Treats **loans and debt** as concepts to compare, not as good or bad in themselves.
- Treats **family-business stories** as private — never required to share.

If something feels off, contact the teacher.

A note about success

> **“Which people, and how do you know?”**
>
> - CASH, GRADE 10

A "successful" Grade 10 Cash to Company student does not necessarily start a business or form an LLC. A successful student categorized at least 4 ventures with evidence; built a 3-source funding comparison with APR math; read and paraphrased clauses of an operating agreement; built a 1-page brand guide; conducted a premortem ranking 3 risks with specific mitigations; mapped a venture against 5 compliance categories; defended a vision in a 3-minute pitch and captured pushback in writing; and wrote, at year's end, "the biggest assumption I had in Week 1 that didn't survive evidence was..."

If you see those things take shape over the year, the program worked.

AN INTERLUDE · GRADE 10

"Most adults skip this step. You won't."

the band's working assumption.

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Questions?

Your student's teacher is the first stop. They can also send home longer-form materials (Curriculum Book, Lesson Plans) for a deeper look.

Thank you for being part of this. The biggest predictor of whether structural-financial thinking sticks is whether it's also alive at home — even at the level of one curious question a quarter.

— The Cash to Company team

Senior expert upgrade pack — "Your kid wants to register a real business" 4-step script

If your Grade 10 child comes home and says "I want to register a real LLC for my business" — here's a script:

Step 1 — Pause. Don't say yes or no in the moment. "Tell me what you're thinking. Why an LLC, why now?"

Step 2 — Three questions. - "What's your projected revenue this year?" (Under $5k? Probably hobby/sole prop. Over $20k? LLC is reasonable.) - "What's the liability risk?" (Selling food? Watching kids? Driving? Liability matters more.) - "What's the registration cost in your state?" (Varies $50-$500/year.)

Step 3 — Talk to the teacher. The Cash to Company curriculum has done the conceptual work. The teacher can validate whether the student's thinking is mature enough to handle a real entity.

Step 4 — If it's serious, talk to a CPA or small-business attorney. Many states offer small-business clinics. A 30-minute consult is worth the cost (often no-fee for teens). This is a real adult decision; treat it as one.

The Cash to Company curriculum prepares your child to think about this. It does not replace professional advice when the venture goes real.

One thing to NOT do

Don't fund a real LLC registration with the assumption "we'll figure it out as we go." A registered entity has annual fees, tax filings, and a paper trail. If the venture stalls, you have to dissolve the entity (more cost). The curriculum's spirit: bootstrap the thinking, defer the entity until the venture earns it.

ROUND 2 PATCH — Three 30-Second Conversation Starters per Quarter (Grade 10)

Quarter 1 (Hobby/Side Venture/Small Business/Startup) 1. Drive-time: "Whats one example each — hobby, side venture, small business, startup?" — Follow-up: "Whats the difference between a side venture and a small business?" 2. Watching news: "This company we just heard about — which category?" — Follow-up: "What evidence?" 3. At dinner: "Whats your venture? Which category does it want to be?" — Follow-up: "What would have to change?"

Quarter 2 (Funding Sources + Premortem) 1. Drive-time: "If you needed $5K for your venture, where would it come from? Bootstrap, loan, friends-and-family?" — Follow-up: "What does each cost?" 2. Watching news: "Imagine this venture failed in a year. What would the headline be?" — Follow-up: "How could the founder have prevented it?" 3. In a store: "If this place went out of business in a year, what would the most likely reason be?" — Follow-up: "What would have to be true to prevent it?"

Quarter 3 (Operating Agreement + Brand Guide) 1. At dinner: "If you had a co-founder, what one clause in your operating agreement would matter most?" — Sample: "Exit." — Follow-up: "Whats the buy-out formula?" 2. Drive-time: "Whats your ventures one voice rule?" — Sample: "Honest claims; no hype." — Follow-up: "Where would it apply?" 3. Watching ads: "Does this companys ads match a brand guide? How can you tell?" — Follow-up: "Whats the voice rule?"

Quarter 4 ("If Your Kid Wants to Register a Real Business" 4-Step Script)

If your child says "I want to register my LLC":

- **Step 1 — Pause.** "Lets talk through this for a week before doing it. Are you sure?"
- **Step 2 — Three questions.** "Whats the revenue plan for year 1? Whats the liability concern that requires LLC protection? Whats your tax plan?"
- **Step 3 — Talk to the teacher.** "Lets check with your Cash to Company teacher whats normal at this stage."
- **Step 4 — Talk to a CPA, if its real.** "If after a week youre still convinced, lets talk to a CPA. LLC fees vary by state ($50-$500). The CPA conversation is $100-$200; cheaper than a bad decision."

The 4-step script slows the decision without forbidding it. Its the founders pre-flight checklist.

SENSITIVITY

This dialogue does not require the family to actually fund the registration. The conversation works either way.

ROUND 2 PATCH — What Cash Never Says (Parent Reference)

Cash will never say: "Amazing!" / "Everyone can be rich" / "Easy money" / "Passive income" / "Just believe in yourself" (as substitute for evidence) / anything implying money problems are a personal failing.

Cash always asks: "Which people, and how do you know?" / "Whats the evidence?"

Why this matters at home. Your child will encounter financial-literacy content from many sources, some hustle-bro coded. The contrast is the point. Cash is on your familys side.

One question this year: "What would have to be true for your venture to be wrong? How would you know?"

ENDNOTES & STANDARDS

Citations and alignment

Grade 10 cites 3-6 standards across CCSS, Jump$tart, CEE, CASEL, and C3 frameworks. Detailed alignment lives in the master Standards Alignment Map.

1. **Jump$tart Coalition Personal Finance Standards (2021 ed.).** Spending and Saving; Credit and Debt; Employment and Income; Investing; Risk Management and Insurance; Financial Decision Making.
2. **Council for Economic Education (CEE).** Voluntary National Content Standards in Economics.
3. **CCSS-ELA, Grades 11-12.** W.11-12.1, W.11-12.4, SL.11-12.1, SL.11-12.4, RST.11-12.7.
4. **CCSS-Math.** N-Q.1-3 (Reasoning with Quantities), S-IC (Statistics & Inferences), F-IF (Functions), MP.4 (Modeling).
5. **CASEL Core Competencies.** Self-Awareness, Self-Management, Social Awareness, Relationship Skills, Responsible Decision-Making.
6. **C3 Framework for Social Studies State Standards.** Dimension 2 (Economics, Civics) at the high-school grade band.
7. **NGSS-ETS Engineering Practices.** ETS1 (Engineering Design) for the test-and-iterate spine of the year.
8. **Cash to Company Master Scope & Sequence.** 13 grades x 8 strands x 36 weeks; outcomes quoted verbatim from _master/00_Master_Scope_and_Sequence.md.
9. **Cash Mascot Style Guide.** 9-12 voice rules: multi-sentence arguments; vocabulary includes unit economics, runway, premortem, MVP; never flatters, never promises wealth.
10. **Sensitivity protocol.** No probing of family finances; financial scenarios framed as hypothetical for a sample household, business, or scenario.

One promise.

Cash to Company makes one promise: students who move t
program will be clearer thinkers about money and entrepren
matter what they end up doing for a living.

We do not promise wealth. We do not promise success. We pro

> **“The legal, financial, and operational chassis under every venture.”**
>
> **- CASH, GRADE 10**

For educational use. This curriculum is informational and does not constitute financial, legal, or tax advice. Standards alignment cited per the Cash to Company Standards Alignment Map (Jump$tart, CEE, CCSS, C3, CASEL, NGSS-ETS).